

Employee Handbook

Effective January 1, 2026 | Version 6.0 | People Operations

1. Welcome to TechCorp

Welcome to TechCorp Inc. This handbook serves as your guide to the policies, procedures, and expectations that govern employment at our company. TechCorp is headquartered in San Francisco, California, with offices in New York, Austin, Seattle, Denver, Chicago, and Boston, as well as a growing remote workforce. We are committed to building a diverse, inclusive, and innovative workplace where every team member can do their best work. Please read this handbook carefully and reach out to your HR Business Partner or People Operations at hr@techcorp.com with any questions.

2. Employment Classifications

TechCorp classifies employees into the following categories based on the nature and duration of their engagement.

Classification	Description	Benefits Eligibility
Full-Time	Regular employees working 40 hours/week on an ongoing basis	Full benefits package
Contract	Fixed-term employees engaged for a specific project or duration (6-24 months)	Limited benefits (see Section 9)
Intern	Students or recent graduates on 3 to 6 month learning assignments	Stipend only, no benefits

3. Probation Period

All new full-time employees are subject to a probation period of 90 calendar days from their date of joining. During probation, either party may terminate the employment relationship with 7 calendar days written notice. Performance is formally evaluated at the 45-day and 90-day marks. Employees who successfully complete probation receive written confirmation and transition to regular employment status. Probation may be extended by up to 30 additional days if the manager and HR agree that more time is needed to assess fit. Contract employees and interns are not subject to probation.

4. Notice Period

When an employee voluntarily resigns from TechCorp, the required notice period is determined by the employee's current level at the time of resignation. The notice period begins on the date the written resignation is formally accepted by the employee's manager and HR.

Employee Level	Notice Period	Garden Leave Eligible
L1 (Junior/Associate)	2 weeks (14 calendar days)	No
L2 (Mid-Level)	30 calendar days	No
L3 (Senior)	60 calendar days	Yes, at company discretion
L4 (Staff/Lead)	60 calendar days	Yes, at company discretion
L5 (Director/VP)	90 calendar days	Yes, mandatory for VP and above

During the notice period, the employee is expected to complete all pending deliverables, transfer knowledge to the designated successor, and return all company property. TechCorp reserves the right to waive part or all of the notice period at its sole discretion, in which case the employee will be paid for the waived notice days. Employees who leave without serving the full notice period (unless waived by the company) will forfeit notice period salary equivalent and may not be eligible for rehire. During probation, the notice period is 7 calendar days regardless of level.

5. Resignation and Exit Process

Employees wishing to resign must submit a written resignation through the HRIS portal or via email to their direct manager with a copy to hr@techcorp.com. The exit process includes the following steps:

1. Submit written resignation specifying the intended last working day.
2. Manager acknowledges and confirms the notice period and last working day.
3. HR schedules an exit interview (typically in the final week of employment).
4. Employee completes a knowledge transfer checklist with their manager.
5. IT Support revokes system access and collects company devices on the last day.
6. HR processes the final settlement, including pending salary, leave encashment, and any deductions.
7. Final settlement is paid within 30 calendar days of the last working day.

6. Flexible Working Hours

TechCorp offers a flexible working hours arrangement to support work-life balance. Under this policy, eligible employees may choose their start and end times within a defined window, provided they maintain the required core hours and total daily work hours.

6.1 Eligibility

Flexible working hours are available to full-time employees in the following departments: Engineering, Product, Data Science, and DevOps. Employees in QA and IT Support are required to follow standard business hours (9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time) due to the nature of their support and testing responsibilities. Contract employees and interns follow the schedule set by their direct manager. Employees on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) are not eligible for flexible hours during the PIP period.

6.2 Core Hours and Flex Window

Employees on flexible hours must be available during core hours of 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM in their local time zone. The flex window extends from 7:00 AM to 10:00 AM for start times and from 3:00 PM to 8:00 PM for end times. All employees must complete a minimum of 8 hours of work per day, exclusive of a 30 to 60 minute lunch break. Flexible schedules must be agreed upon with the direct manager and communicated to the team. Changes to an established flex schedule require 1 week advance notice.

7. Code of Conduct

All TechCorp employees are expected to conduct themselves with professionalism, integrity, and respect. The following principles guide our workplace behavior:

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and partners with dignity and respect.
- Maintain confidentiality of proprietary information, trade secrets, and customer data.
- Avoid conflicts of interest and disclose any potential conflicts to your manager and HR.
- Do not engage in harassment, discrimination, or retaliation in any form.
- Use company resources responsibly and for business purposes.
- Comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies.
- Report any violations of this code through the appropriate channels (manager, HR, or the anonymous ethics hotline).

8. Grievance Redressal Procedure

TechCorp is committed to addressing employee concerns promptly and fairly. Employees who have a workplace grievance should follow this escalation path:

1. Discuss the concern informally with your direct manager.
2. If unresolved, submit a written grievance to your HR Business Partner.
3. HR will investigate and provide a response within 10 business days.
4. If the employee is unsatisfied with the outcome, they may escalate to the VP of People Operations.

5. For matters involving harassment or discrimination, employees may also contact the anonymous ethics hotline at 1-800-555-ETHX.

9. Contract Employee Provisions

Contract employees receive a limited benefits package that includes: access to the company health insurance plan (employee-only coverage at subsidized rates), 401(k) participation without company match, reduced leave entitlements as specified in the Leave Policy, and access to the company learning management system. Contract employees are not eligible for bonuses, stock options, or the family floater insurance plan. Conversion from contract to full-time employment is considered after 12 months of continuous service, subject to manager recommendation and HR approval.